

Application Proof

Badami, Vikas Shrishailappa

Round: R2: 08 January 2025 MBA

Application ID: 185815470

Privacy Consent

By starting this admissions application, I hereby consent to Stanford University's collection and processing of any sensitive personal data contained in my application to evaluate my application and for the other purposes described in Stanford University's Online Privacy Policy, Offline Privacy Policy, and the Privacy Notice for Admissions and Financial Aid which can be found at privacy.stanford.edu.

I Agree

Application Agreement

Members of the Stanford GSB community share a commitment to honesty and integrity. We expect the same commitment from our applicants. When you apply to Stanford, you agree to the application terms below. Some of the language may be dry, but it's important to us and our community, so please read this closely.

Statement of Honesty and Application Integrity

Your electronic signature below represents your agreement to the terms of this application and its instructions and your confirmation/declaration that ALL of the information that you submit in this application is your own work and complete and accurate. Your signature also constitutes your agreement to promptly inform Stanford GSB of any change(s) in the facts presented in your application and your consent to Stanford having the right to verify any information presented in your application.

Your recommenders must be the sole authors of your letters of recommendation. Drafting, writing, translating, or submitting your own recommendations, or having any outside party review or edit them, even if asked to do so by a recommender, is a violation of our application terms. You are responsible for informing your recommenders of this policy.

If you are offered admission, Stanford reserves the right to withdraw that offer if 1) you show a significant drop in academic performance or fail to graduate; 2) there has been a misrepresentation or material omission in or a violation of any of the terms of the application process; 3) we learn that you have engaged in behavior prior to the first day of program attendance that indicates a serious lack of judgment or integrity; or 4) you are simultaneously holding a place at the Stanford MBA Program and at another graduate program (other than for a joint degree, dual degree, or an agreed-upon study opportunity). Stanford further reserves the right to require you to provide additional information and/or authorization for the release of information about any potential concern described in this paragraph. Failure to cooperate in a review of a concern or a request for additional documents relating to a concern is sufficient basis to withdraw admission.

Data Sharing

Note that, in addition to the MBA admission process, your application materials may be used as part of the selection process for another Stanford graduate program to which you may have applied, or that you may apply to once enrolled, including the Knight-Hennessy Scholars program. For applicants jointly applying to multiple Stanford graduate programs: You agree that Stanford GSB may speak with other schools about your MBA application and your qualifications for enrollment.

If you are offered admission, we want you to make an informed decision; for this reason, we may share limited information with Stanford alumni, current students, and/or departments who may contact you to welcome you to the Stanford community and answer any questions you have about the Stanford GSB.

Application Consent

Your application is for the class matriculating in 2025. Stanford considers deferred enrollment for the MBA Program only for eligible candidates. Refer to our [website](#) for eligibility requirements.

The Stanford MBA Program [application fee](#) is nonrefundable. With your signature below, you acknowledge and agree to pay the Stanford MBA Program nonrefundable application fee.

Application materials and supporting information become the property of Stanford University upon submission. We will not return them.

I agree to the terms of this application and its instructions, and I confirm that all of the information that I submit in this application is my own work, complete, and accurate.

First Name

Vikas

Last Name

Badami

Personal Information

Just a few facts to start getting to know you...

Name

Name: Vikas Shrishailappa Badami (Vikas)

Has your name changed? No

If you have a U.S. Social Security number, provide just last four digits for verification purposes.

-

Privacy Protection Policy

We are committed to protecting your privacy.

Upon receiving the secure transmission of the last four digits of your Social Security number, we immediately encrypt that information. This data is only available in plaintext for identification and account matching purposes. Your data is available for decryption only by those officials who oversee automated loading of personal information into student information systems, and only for that limited purpose.

Our databases are actively monitored and are firewalled to ensure the protection of your personal information, and we employ industry-standard safeguards.

Addresses

*Add a permanent address **and** a mailing address. If they are the same, add it twice. Be sure to enter a valid mailing address that is recognized by FedEx and other shipping companies.*

Mailing Address:

Chaitanyavikas Yoga And Nature Cure Center,
27 Srinivas
1st Main 2nd Cross Rajatgiri
Dharwad, Karnataka India 580004
2021-01-01 to 2025-12-31

Permanent Address:

Chaitanyavikas Yoga And Nature Cure Center
27 Srinivas, 1st Main 2nd Cross
Rajatgiri
Dharwad, Karnataka India 580004

Telephone Numbers

Preferred Phone: [Mobile](#)
Home: [+91 94959 50729](#)
Mobile: [+91 63623 25449](#)

Include "+" country code if applicable.

Biographical Information

We are required by U.S. federal guidelines to report the legal sex of each applicant as female or male. Typically, this is the sex indicated on your birth certificate or passport.

Sex: [M](#)

Birthdate: [1998-03-05](#)

Birth Location: [Hunasavalli, Karnataka India](#)

Citizenship Information

List all citizenships you hold. If you are a citizen of two or more countries and the United States is one of them, select the United States as either your Primary or Secondary Citizenship.

Primary Citizenship: [India](#)

Secondary Citizenship: -

Residency Status: -

Important Notes Regarding Residency Status

If, upon beginning your program at the GSB, you are not a U.S. citizen or permanent resident, you will be required to have a visa sponsorship that allows you to study full-time at Stanford. Stanford can provide the I-20 (for F-1 status) or, in some cases, the DS-2019 (for J-1 status) visa sponsorship. **The GSB cannot grant you a deferral if you are in pending permanent residency status.** Students who have pending permanent residency status would not qualify for temporary non immigrant F-1 / J-1 student status.

If you have been granted DACA status, you are eligible to apply and matriculate to Stanford GSB. If you have met all other admission requirements and are otherwise undocumented, you are also eligible to apply and matriculate to Stanford GSB. For more information, please see our [website](#).

How many years (if any) have you lived in the United States? -

Race/Ethnicity

Colleges and universities are asked by many groups, including the U.S. Federal Government, accrediting associations, college guides, and newspapers, to describe the ethnic/racial backgrounds of their students and employees. In order to respond to these requests, we ask you to answer the following two questions.

White: A person having origins in any of the original peoples of Europe, Middle East, or North Africa.

Black or African American: A person having origins in any of the Black racial groups of Africa.

Hispanic or Latino: A person of Cuban, Mexican, Puerto Rican, South or Central American, or other Spanish culture or origin, regardless of race.

Asian: A person having origins in any of the original peoples of the Far East, Southeast Asia, or the Indian subcontinent including, for example, Cambodia, China, India, Japan, Korea, Malaysia, Pakistan, the Philippine Islands, Thailand, and Vietnam.

American Indian or Alaska Native: A person having origins in any of the original peoples of North and South America (including Central America), who maintains cultural identification through tribal affiliation or community attachment.

Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander: A person having origins in any of the original peoples of Hawaii, Guam, Samoa, or other Pacific Islands.

☐ You may decline to answer by checking "Decline to State."

Are you Hispanic or Latino? [No](#)

Regardless of your answer to the prior question, check one or more of the following groups in which you consider yourself to be a member:

☐ American Indian or Alaska Native

☒ Asian

☐ Cambodia

☐ China

☒ India

☐ Japan

☐ Korea

☐ Malaysia

☐ Pakistan

☐ Philippines

☐ Thailand

☐ Vietnam

☐ Other East Asia

☐ Other South Asia

☐ Other Southeast Asia

☐ Black or African American

☐ Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander

☐ White

Gender Identity and Sexuality

Stanford GSB is committed to sustaining a diverse and inclusive educational community. We recognize that sex, gender, and sexuality are distinct and socially constructed categories, and are fluid in ways that available categories may not always capture. We also recognize that sharing information pertaining to sex, gender, and sexuality is personal and answering these questions may be not possible or preferable for you.

The questions below are optional and are intended to encourage self-identification and to allow you to share a more holistic view of your lived experiences.

We encourage you to review [our online privacy policy](#) resources to learn more about how any information in this application may be used.

What pronouns do you use? [He/Him](#)

If you use pronouns that are different from or complementary to those listed above, use the space below to share.
-

How would you identify your gender? [Man](#)

If you use words to identify your gender that are different from or complementary to the words listed above, use the space below to share. -

Do you identify as LGBTQ+? [No](#)

Additional Context

We know that each person is more than a list of facts or pre-defined categories. With this question we provide you with an **optional** opportunity to elaborate on how your background or life experiences have helped shape your recent actions or choices.

[Growing up among the Badaga tribal community, limited resources shaped my outlook on life and leadership. My mother transformed our rented homes into a green oasis, cultivating plants that attracted birds and provided fresh produce, helping us save costs. The healthy meals cooked in earthen pots and the resourceful ways we met our needs ingrained sustainability into every aspect of my life.](#)

[I studied at a \\$30-a-year school that attracted children of migrant laborers and underserved communities, creating a vibrant melting pot of cultures and languages. Kho Kho, often called the poor man's sport, became an instrument of unity amidst this diversity. On the field, we learned to communicate across languages, respect each other's strengths, and build unwavering trust despite our different backgrounds. These experiences forged bonds among us and became my first leadership lessons, showing me how collaboration can turn challenges into triumphs.](#)

Whether it's designing sustainable business models through my consulting, frugal venture development with resourcefulness at Madiee, or fostering diverse, inclusive teams at PeopleGamez, my leadership philosophy has its foundations in my roots.

Family Information

Help us get to know you better by sharing more about your family. Below are some tips about completing this section of the application.

- Tell us a little bit about your parent(s) or guardian(s) by creating individual entries for each of them.
- If you have a spouse/partner and/or child(ren), tell us about them, too. We'd love to learn more about them.
- If you have a close relative who is also planning to submit an application this year for admission to the Stanford MBA Program or the Stanford MSx Program, create an individual entry for them.
- If you have any close relatives who are already admitted to, current students of, graduates of, or employed by the Stanford Graduate School of Business, add their information here.

Name: Sukumari H U

Relationship to you: Mother

☐ This parent/guardian is deceased

Employer: Chaitanya Vikas Yoga and Nature Cure Center

Job Title: Doctor

☐ This parent/guardian is affiliated with Stanford GSB

Did this parent attend or graduate from college? Received the equivalent of a US bachelor's degree

Undergraduate School

Institution Name: JSS College of Naturopathy

Degree: Bachelor (Undeclared) 2008

Graduate School #1

Institution Name: Kuvempu University

Degree: Master of Medicine 2013

Graduate School #2

Institution Name:

Degree:

Name: Shrishailappa Badami

Relationship to you: Father

☐ This parent/guardian is deceased

Employer: SDM University

Job Title: Principal

☐ This parent/guardian is affiliated with Stanford GSB

Did this parent attend or graduate from college? Received the equivalent of a US bachelor's degree

Undergraduate School

Institution Name: Government College Of Pharmacy

Degree: Bachelor (Undeclared) 1987

Graduate School #1

Institution Name: Government College Of Pharmacy

Degree: Maestro 1989

Graduate School #2

Institution Name: Gulbarga University

Degree: Doctor of Pharmacy 1998

Application Information

Miscellaneous Considerations

Have you previously applied to the Stanford MBA or MSx Programs? [No](#)

Are you a current or former Stanford University student or employee? [No](#)

Are you currently serving, on reserve duty, or have you served in the United States military? [No](#)

As permitted by California Education Code 66024.5 for professional degrees, have you ever been convicted of a crime, had a criminal charge sustained against you in a juvenile proceeding, or been placed on a court-supervised probation, or do you currently have a criminal charge pending against you? [No](#)

Joint and Dual Degree Options

Have you or will you be applying to, or are you enrolled in, any joint or dual degree program at Stanford or other study opportunity outside Stanford? [No](#)

Fellowship Opportunities

Please tell us if you are or were a member of any of these organizations.

- ☐ The Consortium
- ☐ Forté
- ☐ JumpStart
- ☐ Management Leadership for Tomorrow (MLT)
- ☐ Riordan MBA Fellows Program
- ☐ ROMBA
- ☐ Questbridge
- ☐ Other

Current Location

For interview planning purposes, tell us where you expect to be located from now until the decision notification date.

Current Location: [New Delhi, Delhi India](#)

Deferral Eligibility

Are/were you a full-time student graduating after September 30, 2023? [No](#)

You will be considered for direct enrollment.

Education

We'd like to hear more about your educational experiences. Add the high school from which you graduated as well as any post-secondary undergraduate or graduate schools (e.g., junior colleges, colleges, universities, or institutes) that you have attended or are currently attending, including for summer sessions, evening classes and transfer credits. List all post-secondary programs you have attended or are currently attending, whether or not you received a degree.

You must also upload an unofficial transcript from the following institutions:

- *Every institution from which you received a degree.*
- *Every institution you have attended for **at least one full academic year** (two semesters or three quarters/trimesters), regardless of the number of credits received.*
- *Any institution you are currently attending from which you expect to receive a degree (this may be an in-progress transcript).*

You do not need to upload a transcript if the name of the transfer institution, course, and grade information already appear on another transcript that you submit. You are not required to submit transcripts for study abroad programs that were less than a year long if the name of the institution, course, and grade information already appear on your transcript. If any transfer or study abroad program information does not include all three requirements, you must upload a transcript for the institution.

Your transcript should include degree conferred and conferral date, if applicable.

Provide all transcript information in the original language and include an English translation if necessary in the same document. Visit our [website for more information on academic transcripts](#).

Undergraduate GPA Instructions

Report your overall and year-by-year grade point average (GPA). Your GPA calculation should match the scale used by your institution and only include courses credited towards your first bachelor's degree:

- Factor in the number of credits and grades for each class; do not simply average quarters or semesters
- Do not convert your college/university's scale
- Calculate and report your GPA in the format in which it appears on your transcript, including using the same number of decimal places
- Report your GPA to the best of your ability, even if your institution does not list it on your transcript. If necessary, you may explain how you reported it in the Additional Information section

For full-time students, report your current GPA. We recognize that this might change later in the school year.

Enter your GPA for each year below. This should not be a cumulative calculation. Enter 0 if this is not applicable in a specific year.

Graduate GPA Instructions

Report your overall and year-by-year grade point average (GPA). Your GPA calculation should match the scale used by your institution and only include courses credited towards your graduate degree:

- Factor in the number of credits and grades for each class; do not simply average quarters or semesters
- Do not convert your college/university's scale
- Calculate and report your GPA in the format in which it appears on your transcript, including using the same number of decimal places
- Report your GPA to the best of your ability, even if your institution does not list it on your transcript. If necessary, you may explain how you reported it in the Additional Information section

For full-time students, report your current GPA. We recognize that this might change later in the school year.

Rank in Class Instructions

Report your rank in class as a fraction. For example, if you were ranked 170th out of 681 students, you would report 170/681. If you do not know your class rank, leave the field blank and do not estimate it.

If your undergraduate institution does not report class ranks but does report percentile ranks, provide that number. For example, top 25% would be reported as 25%. For full-time students, report your current class rank. We recognize that this might change later in the school year. If your school does not rank students or you do not know your class rank, leave the field blank.

Unofficial Transcript Notes

- Scan a copy (front and back) of your unofficial college/university transcript.
- If submitting a screenshot from your school's online system, be sure it includes your name and the school name.
- Include an English translation if your transcript is in a language other than English.
- Since transcripts may contain sensitive information, we ask that you redact identifiers such as Social Security and student identification numbers.
- Optimize the electronic file of your transcript so that it is no more than 2MB.
- Humans, not machines, will read your transcript, so once you've uploaded it, confirm that the scanned transcript is clearly legible, has the institution name on it (and is visible), and is not protected or secured. If you can't read it, we can't read it – and this will delay the processing of your application.

If your transcript is illegible, you cannot meet the requirements above, or you have difficulty uploading a copy of your transcript, you may use the self-reported transcript template and upload it as an alternative. Click [here](#) to

download the self-reported transcript template.

Note: You must complete all required fields, including uploading your transcript if required, to save this information. You may enter placeholder text, but be sure to edit and update it later.

Institution Name: Reimagining Higher Education Foundation (Plaksha University)

School Location: [Gurgaon, Haryana India](#)

Attended from [2020-08-01](#) to [2021-07-01](#)

Level of Study: [Graduate](#)

Did you or will you receive a degree from this institution? [Yes](#)

Degree: [Master of Management](#)

Date Conferred or Expected: [2021-08-01](#)

Major: [Tech Leader Fellowship](#)

GPA

GPA: [3.49](#)

GPA Scale: [4.0](#)

 [Transcript Uploaded](#) (scroll to bottom to view)

Institution Name: Sarvodaya Pre-University College

School Location: [Tumkur, Karnataka India](#)

Attended from [2014-06-01](#) to [2016-05-01](#)

Level of Study: [High School](#)

Institution Name: National Institute of Technology Calicut (NIT Calicut)

School Location: [Calicut, Kerala India](#)

Attended from [2016-07-01](#) to [2020-05-01](#)

Level of Study: [Undergraduate](#)

Did you or will you receive a degree from this institution? [Yes](#)

Degree: [Bachelor of Technology](#)

Date Conferred or Expected: [2020-11-01](#)

Major: [Production Engineering](#)

Major Field: [Engineering/Computer Science](#)

Second Major: -

Second Degree:-

Second Major Field:-

Third Major: -

Third Degree:-

Third Major Field: -

Minor(s): -

GPA

GPA Scale: [10](#)

GPA: [8.18](#)

Enter your GPA for each year below. This should not be a cumulative calculation. Enter 0 if this is not applicable in a specific year.

GPA by Year: [8.41](#) | [7.78](#) | [7.99](#) | [8.69](#) | |

Rank in Class: -

 [Transcript Uploaded](#) (scroll to bottom to view)

Stanford GSB Admissions considers an applicant first-generation when neither parent holds a bachelor's degree from a four-year college or university.

☐ I am/was a first-generation college student.

Miscellaneous Information

Have you ever been suspended, dismissed, or placed on enforced leave from any college or university, or been the subject of disciplinary action by such an institution, or are you currently the subject of a pending disciplinary proceeding (note that such proceedings might include, but not be limited to, honor code, code of conduct, or Title IX matters)? [No](#)

Have you ever been placed on academic probation or been other than in good academic standing at any college or university, or is an academic standing proceeding pending against you? [No](#)

Undergraduate Funding Sources

Tell us how you funded your undergraduate education (tuition, room and board, and other expenses) and make sure the four values below total 100%. You may estimate these percentages to the best of your ability.

If higher education in your country or at the colleges or universities you attended is provided tuition-free, check the box below, and use the four percentage fields to indicate how you paid for any other education-related expenses, such as room and board, books and supplies, etc.

☐ My undergraduate education was tuition-free

Employment: [10](#)

Loans: [90](#)

Family: [0](#)

Scholarships/Grants: [0](#)

Awards and Honors

If you have received any significant academic awards, honors, or recognitions, please tell us about them here. In the Basis of Selection field, explain the award criteria, how often the award is given, who selected the recipients, and the number applied and selected, if this information is available.

Harvard US India Initiative

Level: [International](#)

Date Received: [February 2021](#)

Basis of Selection: [I was one of the 100 delegates selected for the program based on academic excellence, leadership potential, commitment to social issues, and diversity of experience.](#)

Global Venture Catalyst

Level: [International](#)

Date Received: [January 2021](#)

Basis of Selection: [I was among the 170 students from select top global research universities and MBA programs representing 30+ countries for the inaugural edition of the Global Venture Catalyst initiative of UC Berkeley. The selection was based on past research projects and work experience.](#)

100% Merit Scholarship

Level: [National](#)

Date Received: [August 2020](#)

Basis of Selection: [I was selected in recognition of consistent academic achievements, demonstrated entrepreneurial initiatives, and strong leadership potential.](#)

Pi School of AI Scholar

Level: [International](#)

Date Received: [December 2019](#)

Basis of Selection: [I was selected from 6000+ applicants. The program annually selects 20 scholars. Despite not meeting their minimum eligibility criterion, I was selected as the youngest and 21st scholar in 2019 on the basis of my past AI projects and exceptional potential. The selection process included resume screening, project presentations, three technical interview rounds, case studies, and two business-focused interviews with the program director.](#)

Top 10 Venture Ideas at Startup Conclave

Level: [National](#)

Date Received: [March 2019](#)

Basis of Selection: [My Artificially Intelligent Messaging Tent Prototype was selected among the Top 10 startup ideas from 1000+ nationwide applicants at a startup conclave hosted by the prestigious National Institute of](#)

Additional Coursework

If you have completed or are in progress of completing any additional coursework not shown on your transcripts (e.g., professional certifications, MBA prep classes, English enrichment classes, etc.), provide relevant information here.

I have completed several Coursera certifications including Successful Negotiation, Leading Teams, Influencing People, Inspiring and Motivating Individuals, and AI for Medical Diagnosis and Prognosis. These courses enhanced my leadership, communication, and technical skills.

Languages

If you speak one or more languages other than English assess your proficiency in these languages using the guidelines in the Language section of our website. Let us know if you speak any languages other than English, and to what level of proficiency. Speaking a language other than English is not required for admission to Stanford GSB.

Language: Telugu

Proficiency: Level 3: Professional working proficiency

Language: Kannada

Proficiency: Level 5: Native or bilingual proficiency

Language: Tamil

Proficiency: Level 2: Limited working proficiency

Language: Hindi

Proficiency: Level 4: Full professional proficiency

Language: Sanskrit

Proficiency: Level 1: Elementary proficiency

Test Scores

By submitting this application, you hereby authorize the relevant testing agency to share individual information with Stanford University, including information about any of your test scores on which questions of validity have been raised.

Although you must arrange to have the testing agency send your official test scores to us as part of the application process, those official scores may arrive after the application deadline. We will not confirm their receipt, but we will reach out to you if we have a problem accessing them.

If you have taken the GMAT Exam, review the information below to determine which GMAT test version to select when reporting your scores.

GMAT - Previous Version: Offered from 2012 to 2024, the previous GMAT version had total scores ending in a “0” and contained four test components:

- Verbal Reasoning
- Quantitative Reasoning
- Integrated Reasoning
- Analytical Writing Assessment (AWA) *Not applicable for online tests

GMAT - Current Version: Offered since November 2023, the current GMAT version has total scores ending in a “5” and three test components:

- Verbal Reasoning
- Quantitative Reasoning
- Data Insights

Tests must be taken before the deadline date of the application round in which you plan to apply. Scores from tests taken after the deadline date will not be considered. You must self-report your scores on your application and send us your official scores via the score reporting center. If you do not yet have your test scores, enter “0” in each test

score and percentage field in the application. GMAT score reports may not be available until up to five business days after your test date, and GRE score reports may not be available until up to 15 business days after your test date. **We strongly encourage you to take the test of your choice at least a few weeks before the application deadline of the round in which you apply to ensure that you can self-report your scores on your application.**

Interviews will not be granted without a valid test score submitted to Stanford.

If you have an undergraduate or graduate degree from a college or university that provided instruction entirely in English (other than foreign language classes), then you are exempt from taking the TOEFL, IELTS, or PTE. However, if your college or university taught some classes in a language other than English, you must take the TOEFL, IELTS, or PTE. Neither your citizenship nor your work experience exempts you from taking the TOEFL, IELTS, or PTE.

If you have further questions, visit our [website](#) for more information about reporting test scores.

Type: **GMAT - Current Version**

Test Date: 2024-04-08

Overall Score: 695 (98%)

Verbal Reasoning: 85 (96%)

Quantitative Reasoning: 84 (85%)

Data Insights: 84 (98%)

☐ I have taken the GMAT and/or GRE more than once.

Activities and Interests

Help us get to know you better by sharing how you spend your time outside of your primary job responsibilities or classes. Examples of activities in which you are/have been involved may include athletic, charitable, civic, community, company-sponsored, or professional. A sustained depth of commitment in a few activities may demonstrate your passion more than minimal participation in many.

Tell us about the activities and interests **during and since** college that are significant and meaningful to you.

If you are applying for direct admission for next fall and an internship or part-time job during college was an important activity for you, you may list it here (though it's not required). Meaningful post-graduate part-time work should go in the "Professional Experience" section.

If you are applying for deferred enrollment, list any internships (paid or unpaid) or part-time work during college or graduate school in the "Professional Experience" section.

Name: **Board Games**

Start Date: 2022-12-01 to

Members: 200

Hours: 500 per Year

Role: Facilitator and Co-organizer

Description As a board game enthusiast, I turned my passion into a community-building initiative by co-organizing bi-monthly sessions, using games as a tool to help strangers bond, develop trust, and foster meaningful connections.

Name: **Spiritual trail**

Start Date: 2022-02-01 to

Members: 12

Hours: 200 per Year

Role: Organizer

Description I design and run inner and outward discovery-focused outbound trails, adventures, and indoor experiences, typically with a small community of audience who are open to being vulnerable with strangers and embracing new experiences. Board games, trekking, hitchhiking, etc are some of the tools I leverage.

Name: **Venture Capital**

Start Date: 2022-01-01 to

Members: 4

Hours: 250 per Year

Role: Evaluating and Mentoring Startups

Description Advised Treeforest Capital, a family fund, on evaluating startups and mentoring founders on growth and strategy. Recommended two ventures for investment, one of which secured funding on Shark Tank India. Previously collaborated with Act Grants and Jagriti Enterprise Center in similar roles.

Name: Mentorship

Start Date: 2018-05-01 to

Members: 19

Hours: 300 per Year

Role: Mentorship

Description Through OpenTech, Jagriti Yatra, Learning Wheels, and other engagements, I'm mentoring 18 founders, most of them college dropouts, on strategic dilemmas and entrepreneurial struggles.

Name: Robotics Interest Group (College Club)

Start Date: 2016-11-01 to 2018-02-01

Members: 50

Hours: 500 per Year

Role: Team Lead

Description Led a team of 14 people on projects ranging from self-learning robots to shaping changing ball-robot leading to following achievements:

Semi-Finalist at Flipkart Grid ML Challenge (selected among 6700 teams Nationwide)

Finalist at Kerala XR Challenge

(Our industrial XR prototype was among the top 10 ideas in Kerala)

Name: OpenTech - Community workshops

Start Date: 2016-10-01 to 2021-05-01

Members: 22

Hours: 1200 per Year

Role: Founder, Facilitator

Description Led a team of 23 to train 10,000+ underprivileged students in robotics, AI, and leadership. During the pandemic, scaled OpenTech online as Project Uplift with a former participant. Recognized as a top 3 Asian project for community transformation by United Peoples Global, a UN initiative.

Name: KhoKho

Start Date: 2008-05-01 to

Members: 20

Hours: 750 per Year

Role: Captain, Coach and Player

Description State-level champion, national player, and school Kho Kho captain. Realizing NIT Calicut lacked KhoKho Infrastructure, I collaborated with the administration and manually constructed the ground, eventually building my team. To this day, I start my mornings with the sport, which keeps me grounded and focused.

Awards and Honors

If you have received any significant awards, honors, or recognitions for the activities you list in this section, please tell us about them. In the Basis of Selection field, explain the award criteria, how often the award is given, who selected the recipients, and the number applied and selected, if this information is available.

Youth Icon

Level: National

Date Received: January 2025

Basis of Selection: One among the 40 people selected by the Ministry of Youth Affairs, Government of India through a democratic and merit-based national selection process. The ministry evaluated individuals from across India for their exceptional contributions to youth empowerment through entrepreneurial endeavors.

Host at Ecoversity's Education Conference

Level: [International](#)

Date Received: [March 2021](#)

Basis of Selection: [Selected as 1 of 12 hosts for Ecoversity's \(global community of un-schoolers\) Reimagining Education Conference, recognizing my innovative contributions to experiential learning.](#)

Jagriti Yatra

Level: [National](#)

Date Received: [December 2020](#)

Basis of Selection: [Top 1% selected from 15k+ applicants with 90% scholarship for exemplary community contributions and proven societal impact. The program involves an 8000km train journey across India while working on a social business model.](#)

DRUSE

Level: [Regional/State](#)

Date Received: [March 2018](#)

Basis of Selection: [Among the 14 teams selected from across South India \(top 3 teams in Kerala and the only team from NIT Calicut out of 20+ participants\), selected for innovation, feasibility, and 18 other criteria. Received special mention from the Director of DRDO, India's National Defence Body, for our unique approach to the problem statement.](#)

KhoKho Gold Medalist

Level: [Regional/State](#)

Date Received: [March 2011](#)

Basis of Selection: [I played two KhoKho Nationals in 2011 and 2013 respectively after securing First place in the regional-level sports meet organized by the Central Board of Secondary Education.](#)

Professional Experience

We want to know about all the great work you've done, as well as your future aspirations. Your professional experience is one of the ways in which you can demonstrate the impact you've had on organizations. Just a reminder: by submitting your application, you have agreed to let us verify your employment information.

Employment Information

How much full-time work experience, if any, will you have had between completing your first undergraduate degree and September 2025?

Years: [4](#)

Months: [0](#)

Are you currently employed? [Yes](#)

In which industry are you currently employed? (If you are a full-time student, select "College Senior" or "Graduate Student" even if you are also working part-time.) [Consulting](#)

If you are admitted and commit to enroll, may we contact your current employer? [Other](#)

Explain: [Yes. You may contact my co-founder, Srushti Basavaraddi](#)

Have you had any gap(s) of four months or more in your employment or educational history since secondary school? [No](#)

We know life is full of ups and downs. If you have ever been disciplined by or involuntarily terminated from an employer or organization, check the box below and explain the circumstances in the section below.

☐ You have been disciplined by or involuntarily terminated from an employer or organization.

Employment History

We appreciate learning about your accomplishments from your resume, but would like additional context around

your work experience. Below are some tips about completing this section of the application.

If you are applying for direct enrollment for next fall's class:

- Include all post-graduate full-time work experiences.
- Create one entry per position held. If you've held multiple positions with the same employer, including promotion(s) to another role, you will need to create multiple entries.
- Don't list positions held during college (e.g., internships and part-time work) in this section. Instead, use the "Activities & Interests" section if you feel any work experience you had during college is critical to include.
- Meaningful post-graduate part-time work may be included here.
- Indicate whether you left a previous job(s) and tell us why to help us understand your career path and what has motivated your decision making.

If you are applying for deferred enrollment:

- Include internships (paid or unpaid) and part-time work from college or graduate school in this section.
- Don't list positions held prior to starting college.

You must complete all required fields to save this information. You may enter placeholder text, but be sure to edit and update it later.

Annual Salary:

- Enter your starting and ending salaries in the currencies in which you were paid.
- Do not include bonuses in your salary information. Enter any bonuses in the Annual Bonus fields.
- If this is your current position, list your current salary in the Ending/Current field.
- Annualize your salary for part-time positions. If further explanation is required, you may note that in Additional Information.

Annual Bonus:

- Enter your starting and ending annual bonuses in the currencies in which you were paid.
- If this is your current position, list your annual bonus in the Ending/Current field.
- Enter only your annual performance bonus. Exclude signing bonuses, relocation compensation, stock or equity grants, etc. If further explanation is required, you may note that in Additional Information.

Organization/Employer: MetaXP Private Limited (PeopleGamez.com)

Industry Category: Consulting

Nature of Organization/Employer's Activities:

Strategy consulting firm that helps purpose-driven organizations with strategic realignment and new initiatives centered on market positioning, organic growth, and customer loyalty

Approximately how many people does your organization employ? 2-5

If you are able to share, what is the total yearly revenue of your company in US dollars? 42500

Job Title: Chief Executive Officer

Function: Mgmt - Corporate Officer - CEO

☒ Check here if you are the founder/co-founder of this company.

Location: Dharwad, Karnataka India

☒ Check here if this is your primary current job. You may only select one.

Start of Employment: 2022-04-01

Number of employees you supervised (direct reports only): 5

Annual Salary

Starting: 5800 | Currency: Indian Rupee

Ending/Current: 2740 | Currency: Indian Rupee

Annual Bonus

☒ This employer does not provide annual bonuses.

Your primary job responsibilities:

I lead strategy, business development, and client deliverables, overseeing strategic pivots and international expansion. I manage partnerships with global leadership ventures and equip trainers with our simulations by conducting train-the-trainer sessions.

This job is/was: Full-time employment

☐ Check here if this employer is financially sponsoring your Stanford GSB studies.

Organization/Employer: **Madiee Games Private Limited**

Industry Category: **Consulting**

Nature of Organization/Employer's Activities:

A corporate training firm specializing in leadership development and organizational integration through behavioral simulations, focusing on strategic and managerial skills.

Approximately how many people does your organization employ? **100-499**

If you are able to share, what is the total yearly revenue of your company in US dollars? -

Job Title: Chief Operating Officer

Function: **Mgmt - Corporate Officer - COO**

☒ Check here if you are the founder/co-founder of this company.

Location: **Erode, Tamil Nadu India**

☐ Check here if this is your primary current job. You may only select one.

Start of Employment: **2021-08-01**

End of Employment: **2022-03-01**

Number of employees you supervised (direct reports only): **12**

Annual Salary

Starting: **0** | Currency: **Indian Rupee**

Ending/Current: **0** | Currency: **Indian Rupee**

Annual Bonus

☒ This employer does not provide annual bonuses.

Your primary job responsibilities:

Co-founded Madiee, scaling the team from 2 to 118 while scaling processes for efficiency. Led game design, hiring strategy, and strategic partnerships to enhance operations and deliver innovative team-building solutions for diverse clients.

This job is/was: **Full-time employment**

Reason for leaving:

Although Senthil and I shared a broader vision, our perspectives differed on the organization's direction, resulting in us mutually parting ways.

Upload your resume (A good rule of thumb is one page per decade of experience. For less than 10 years of experience, one page is usually enough.)

 **Resume Uploaded** (scroll to bottom to view)

Awards and Honors

Please list any significant professional awards, honors, or recognitions you have received. In the Basis of Selection field, explain the award criteria, how often the award is given, who selected the recipients, and the number applied and selected, if this information is available.

TIDE 2.0 Grant

Level: **National**

Date Received: **June 2023**

Basis of Selection: **The TIDE 2.0 grant is awarded by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology based on several criteria, primarily focusing on startups (pan-India) that are working on emerging technologies addressing societal and business challenges.**

AEE APAC Conference Speaker Invite

Level: **International**

Date Received: **May 2023**

Basis of Selection: **Recognizing the relevance and impact of my work on data-driven simulations and leadership development, I was invited to share my works and insights at an international conference on experiential learning.**

Startup India Seed Fund

Level: [National](#)

Date Received: [March 2023](#)

Basis of Selection: The selection is based on criteria such as the innovativeness of the idea, market potential, scalability, and team capability. Less than 1% of all startups who applied from across India received funding.

Toycathon

Level: [National](#)

Date Received: [June 2021](#)

Basis of Selection: A 3-stage competition involving game idea submissions, prototype development, and finals involving real-time optimizations of prototype based on feedback of Judges. I led my team at Madiee to win among 129000+ participants.

Post-GSB Aspirations

Briefly share your short- and long-term professional aspirations after graduating from Stanford GSB.

[Post-MBA, I will work as Chief of Staff at enterprise companies like Indeed or Scale AI before returning to PeopleGamez, establishing it in the US, and progressing towards my vision of helping purpose-driven businesses drive societal impact.](#)

Select the industry and job function that most closely reflect your post-GSB goal. This isn't a commitment; you can still change your mind during the program.

Desired Industry: [Tech - Software](#)

Desired Function: [Strategy - Planning](#)

Essays

We request that you write two personal essays.

In each essay, we want to hear your genuine voice. Think carefully about your values, passions, aims, and dreams. There is no "right answer" to these questions—the best answer is the one that is truest for you.

Essay A: What matters most to you, and why?

For this essay, we would like you to reflect deeply and write from the heart. Once you've identified what matters most to you, help us understand why. You might consider, for example, what makes this so important to you? What people, insights, or experiences have shaped your perspectives?

Essay B: Why Stanford?

Describe your aspirations and how your Stanford GSB experience will help you realize them.

Length

Both essays combined may not exceed 1,000 words. We recommend up to 650 words for Essay A and up to 350 words for Essay B. We often read effective essays that are written in fewer words.

Formatting

- Double-spaced
- Number all pages
- Upload one document that includes both essays

Be sure to save a copy of your essays, and preview the uploaded document to ensure that the formatting is preserved. Please visit our [website](#) for additional guidance on writing your essays.

 [Essays Uploaded](#) (scroll to bottom to view)

Short Answer Question

In this section, we provide an optional opportunity for you to discuss some of your contributions more fully.

What do we mean by "optional"? We mean you have the opportunity to choose. In evaluating your application, we want to know about who you are and how you think Stanford will help you achieve your aspirations. We are also interested in learning about the things you have done that are most meaningful to you. If you feel that you've already addressed these questions well in other areas of the application, congratulations, you're done!

If you would like to discuss your contributions more fully, this section is the place to do so. Perhaps you would like to expand upon a bullet item from your resume and tell us more about the "how" or "why" behind the "what." Or maybe you have had impact in a way that doesn't fit neatly in another part of the application. You are welcome to share up to three examples (up to 1,200 characters, or approximately 200 words, for each example).

Question:

Think about a time in the last few years when you've created a positive impact, whether in professional, extracurricular, academic, or other settings. What was your impact? What made it significant to you or to others?

"He's not ready for a leadership role," our CEO at Madiee referred to a design lead I had recommended for VP of Design. I understood the concern wasn't about the designer's stammer but his confidence. He'd once shared, "I avoid speaking up, not due to lack of insights but fear my stammer will make them seem weak." Other team members had smirked during his presentations, leaving him isolated.

As an entrepreneur, my team is the most important thing to me. Their growth and success are my responsibility. Determined to help, I counseled my team to create a more inclusive environment while encouraging the designer to embrace his stammer as part of his story, not a weakness. I introduced him to differently-abled professionals who had transformed vulnerabilities into strengths, inspiring him to see himself in a new light.

I also worked to build a culture of mutual support, publicly recognizing small acts of empowerment across the team. As few team members followed suit by sharing how his design reviews improved their work, their managers sought his guidance. Soon, I saw him hosting workshops and eventually earning a promotion from CEO, benefiting not just him but the entire organization

☒ Check here to add another example

I was introduced to GrowthPal, an M&A marketplace on the brink of collapse through their strategic advisor, Sugato. As a consultant, I was tasked to address their uncertain revenues, executive resignations, and a demoralized team.

To restore confidence and drive clarity, I hosted a workshop with the entire GrowthPal team where I introduced a first-of-its-kind simulation named "ProfitLane" that my team at PeopleGamez had developed. This simulation at the workshop not only revealed gaps in the existing revenue model but also empowered the team to identify a subscription-based approach that stabilized revenue.

Through user interviews and brainstorming sessions, we identified innovative ideas and developed tailored evaluations, saving CFOs over 500 hours annually. This led to tangible results: larger deal sizes, securing Series A funding, and initiating global expansion. Most importantly, the team regained their confidence and belief in their ability to succeed.

Observing their journey to a solution taught me the power of stepping back, trusting the process, and enabling others to take ownership of success in creating sustainable impact.

☒ Check here to add another example

Through OpenTech, Jagriti Yatra, and numerous other engagements, I've bonded closely with 18 entrepreneurs who call me their mentor and form my support system.

One among them is Suyashi whom I met during an OpenTech workshop in 2018. Recognizing her passion for Japanese culture, I connected her with language teachers, enabling her to win the Marching J scholarship and represent India in Japan. During the pandemic, she proposed taking OpenTech online as Project Uplift. I helped her scale the program, impacting 1000s of students and earning recognition as one of Asia's top three projects by United People Global, a UN initiative. Since the passing of her father, the sole breadwinner, I've been supporting her and her family in building entrepreneurial income streams to support themselves in these challenging times.

For me, the ripple effect of mentorship is deeply fulfilling. Suyashi's journey highlighted how guidance can multiply impact. Similarly, I supported Naman in building a skill-based social media platform that now connects over 5000

teenagers and guided Shivank with his content strategy, helping him grow his podcast to 65000+ subscribers, amplifying stories of entrepreneurs.

Additional Information

We are deliberate in the questions we ask. We believe that we get to know you well through all of the elements of your application. Complete this section only if you have critical information you could not convey elsewhere on your application (e.g., extenuating circumstances affecting academic or work performance). This section should not be used as an additional essay.

At Plaksha, I launched Madiie while balancing coursework, supported by the administrative team. A personal emergency of my co-founder forced me to handle a critical project, leading to an attendance shortage in the intensive 2-week 'Persuasive Presence 3' course. This resulted in my failing grade due to insufficient attendance. I kindly request the admissions team to consider my prior academic performance, where I ranked highest with a 4.0/4.0 GPA in both 'Persuasive Presence 1 [CL 002]' and 'Persuasive Presence 2 [CL 006],' as evidence of my academic readiness.

At PeopleGamez, I supervise 8-15 freelancers who are hired on a need basis. I also reinvest our profits to build assets and only take director remuneration in emergencies, hence my application lists a near-zero salary. However, PeopleGamez is a profitable and bootstrapped venture with \$42K ARR.

Letters of Recommendation

What to submit

This is your chance to let someone else tell us how great you are! Please solicit two letters of recommendation for your MBA application.

- One recommendation from your current direct supervisor (or next best alternative) at work
- One recommendation from someone else who has supervised your work

Notify your recommenders which type of letter of recommendation they will be completing for you (Current Direct Supervisor or Other) and in which round you will be applying.

Your recommenders must be the sole authors of your letters of recommendation. Drafting, writing, translating, submitting your own recommendations, or having any outside party review or edit them, even if asked to do so by a recommender, is a violation of our application terms. You are responsible for informing your recommenders of this policy.

Technical advice: Please ask your recommenders to set their email filters to allow emails from @stanford.edu and @gsb.stanford.edu.

How to submit

Your recommenders are required to submit their letters through our online form by the deadline of the round in which you apply. Register your recommenders by clicking the **Add Recommender** button below.

1. Provide the name and contact information of each person who will be recommending you. Check the email address for each recommender carefully. You cannot change it later. If there is an error, **Exclude** the recommender and add their information again. It is essential that you enter the recommender's email address correctly so that your recommender can access the instructions and recommendation form.
2. Read the waiver statement for each letter of recommendation and determine whether or not you will waive your right to review each recommendation. **You cannot change this later.**
3. Click on the **Send to Recommender** button. We will send an email to the recommender with instructions on how to proceed. Check with your recommender to make sure they receive it.
4. Your recommender completes and submits their recommendation.
5. You and your recommender receive an email confirming the recommendation has been submitted.

You can check the status of your letters of recommendation anytime by logging in to your application or your applicant status portal once you have submitted your application. Your recommenders must submit their letters of recommendation through an online form. They may not email, mail, or fax letters of recommendation. Both letters of recommendation must be submitted by the deadline of the round in which you apply.

Ready to submit your application? Wait! Read this first.

- You will not be able to submit your application until you have notified two recommenders.
- You don't have to wait until both letters are in before submitting your application. Go ahead and submit when you are ready, but remember to follow up and make sure your recommenders submit their letters by

the deadline.

- If a recommender hasn't submitted a letter yet and you would like to remind them, click on the recommender's record and then click **Remind Recommender**.

If you need to change recommenders after notifying two, you must first exclude a recommender by clicking on their name, then clicking on **Exclude**. You will then be able to add a new recommender.

Still have questions? For more information on letters of recommendation, please review the instructions on our [website](#).

If you are not submitting a letter of recommendation from your current direct supervisor, explain here by selecting the primary reason. [I am self-employed/run my own business](#)

Recommenders

Name: [Rishi Khanna](#)

Telephone Number (include +country code): [+91 98100 75278](#)

Email Address: rishi@treeforest.capital

☐ This is a personal (non-professional) email address

Institution/Organization: [TreeForest Capital](#)

Position/Title: [Founder and Chairman](#)

Is this your current direct supervisor? [No](#)

How do you know this recommender?

[Rishi has been my professional and personal mentor since my time at Plaksha](#)

If you would like to display a different name for yourself to this recommender, type it here. -

The Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act of 1974

Once you are a student in attendance, the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act of 1974 (FERPA) provides you with a right of access to your education record, including letters of recommendation if they are retained by the school. The law also permits you to waive that right of access to your letters of recommendation, if you so choose. Waiving your right of access to your letters of recommendation is optional, and your decision to waive or retain that right will have no bearing on your admission decision. Your recommender will see your choice.

Carefully consider your answer to this question. **Upon sending this form to your recommender, you will no longer be able to change your decision about whether to waive your right.**

Do you wish to waive your right to examine this letter of recommendation? [Yes](#)

Personal message to recommender:

-

In place of your signature, type your full legal name: [Vikas Shrishailappa Badami](#)

Name: [Solomon Salvis](#)

Telephone Number (include +country code): [+91 93226 06868](#)

Email Address: solomon@simurise.com

☐ This is a personal (non-professional) email address

Institution/Organization: [SimuRise Learning Private Limited](#)

Position/Title: [Chief Executive Officer](#)

Is this your current direct supervisor? [No](#)

How do you know this recommender?

[Solomon has been a repeat client for PeopleGamez.](#)

If you would like to display a different name for yourself to this recommender, type it here. -

The Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act of 1974

Once you are a student in attendance, the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act of 1974 (FERPA) provides you with a right of access to your education record, including letters of recommendation if they are retained by the school. The law also permits you to waive that right of access to your letters of recommendation, if you so choose. Waiving your right of access to your letters of recommendation is optional, and your decision to waive or retain that right will have no bearing on your admission decision. Your recommender will see your choice.

Carefully consider your answer to this question. **Upon sending this form to your recommender, you will**

no longer be able to change your decision about whether to waive your right.

Do you wish to waive your right to examine this letter of recommendation? [Yes](#)

Personal message to recommender:

-

In place of your signature, type your full legal name: [Vikas Shrishailappa Badami](#)

Materials

[Resume](#) uploaded 2025-01-08 15:59

[Essays](#) uploaded 2025-01-05 02:21

[National Institute of Technology Calicut \(NIT Calicut\) Undergraduate Transcript](#) uploaded 2024-12-28 13:26

[Reimagining Higher Education Foundation \(Plaksha University\) Graduate Transcript](#) uploaded 2024-12-28 13:24

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